

# Delaware County Commissioners Meeting December 16th 2024

| Meeting Metadata | Details                                                                                               |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Video Recording  | <a href="https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=V9MsGFaERtQ">https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=V9MsGFaERtQ</a> |
| Publication Date | 2024-12-17T02:59:18Z                                                                                  |
| Target Category  | delaware_county                                                                                       |

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

## Delaware County Commissioner Meeting Summary

**Meeting Date:** December 16, 2024

**Body:** Delaware County Commissioners

### 1. Pre-Hearing & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** Public Hearing on the Delaware County Multi-Hazard Mitigation Plan Update [00:01:07](#)
- **Summary of Discussion:** John Cino, Emergency Management Director, and Troy Jester of Vantage Point Consulting presented the updated multi-hazard mitigation plan. Funded via state/federal grants, the plan is updated every five years (incorporating climate change, active threats, and updated demographics) to maintain eligibility for FEMA mitigation funds. Public and municipal feedback was robust. No members of the public spoke against the plan. The public hearing was closed by roll call vote ([00:06:41](#)), followed by a motion to adopt the plan as presented, which passed successfully.

## 2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

---

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Called to order by the presiding officer at 9:03 AM on Monday, December 16, 2024 00:00:25.
  - **Attendance:**
    - **Presiding Officer / Board Members Present:** Dr. (First name unstated/Dr. King), Mr. Henry, Mr. Reagan.
    - **Absent:** None noted.
- 

## 3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

---

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opening invocation and Pledge of Allegiance 00:00:32.
  - **Approval of Minutes:**
    - Motion to take the November 18 meeting minutes off the table and approve them: Approved by roll call vote 00:08:22.
    - Motion to approve the December 2 meeting minutes: Approved by roll call vote 00:08:54.
- 

## 4. Substantive Business & Board Action

---

- **00:09:14 Presentation: IRAX Program Update & Funding Request**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jamie Blevens (Integrated Re-entering Correctional Support / IRAX).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Blevens presented program metrics since July 2022: 2,910 participants served, 23,445 engagements, 274 current active participants in-jail, and a recidivism rate of 16.1%. Due to a new 30% match requirement from the state (FSSA and MHA), IRAX requested an increase in county support from \$50,000 to \$75,000. Commissioners acknowledged the exceptional results and noted they will review EDIT (Economic Development Income Tax) funds to see if funding can be provided.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal vote taken.
- **00:14:16 Property Tax Abatement Petition: Muncie Sanitary District**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick Conrad, District Administrator, Muncie Sanitary District.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** The District purchased a vacant, under-a-quarter-acre property at 1725 East Jackson Street to establish a new line of protection for the South Levy system (protecting over \$200 million in property). The property carries \$2,616.77 in unpaid taxes. The auditor, assessor, and treasurer support abating these taxes.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Mr. Henry: Yes, Mr. Reagan: Yes, Dr. King: Yes) 00:16:17.

- **00:16:50 Fairgrounds Employee Handbook and Job Descriptions**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tom E., Vice President of Delaware County Fairgrounds / Melanie Marshall.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Updated the employee handbook (last revised in 2012) and created standardized job descriptions. Updates include transitioning to PTO (combining personal and sick days) and clarifying that employees driving personal vehicles on fair business are not covered by county insurance. The fair board approved the changes on November 19.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Mr. Henry: Yes, Mr. Reagan: Yes, Dr. King: Yes) **00:18:53**.
- **00:19:28 Liquid Asphalt Contract Extension**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Highway / Engineering.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Contract extension for liquid asphalt used for paving and chip-and-seal projects, locking in 2023 pricing.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote **00:19:43**.
- **00:19:58 County Employee Handbook Revisions**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Pam (HR Director) / John.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Revisions include clarifying PTO administration, updating level one/two offense tiers, cleaning up typos, removing union contract references, and standardizing policies across departments. County Council member Matt Couch requested a delay pending the formation of a new HR committee in January. After debate regarding urgency, commissioners agreed to table the item.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled by Roll Call Vote **00:23:51**.
- **00:24:10 Stop-Loss Gap Policy Contract (Health Insurance)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Pam (HR Director).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual renewal for self-funded health insurance stop-loss coverage for claims exceeding the \$200,000 retention threshold.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote **00:25:07**.
- **00:25:21 Progress Rail Exterior Equipment Pad Drainage Variance**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** John (for Angie).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for a drainage variance to allow Progress Rail to proceed with industrial site development.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote **00:26:34**.
- **00:26:45 Road Repair Agreement (Detour Damage)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Highway Department / Engineering Office.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Following heavy detour traffic over the summer on Black Branch Road and Grandville, Greenfield agreed to an estimated repair/repaving cost of \$21,449.60 based on comprehensive video/photo documentation by county staff.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote **00:28:13**.
- **00:28:28 General Services & LPA Consulting Agreements (Triad Associates)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Highway/Engineering staff.

- **Deliberation Summary:**
  1. Agreement increase of \$1,732 for Bridge 112 project (County Road 600 South, built in 1955).
  2. Two-year general services agreement with Triad Associates at \$15,000 per year for as-needed engineering consulting.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote [00:29:14](#) and [00:30:08](#).
- [00:30:21](#) **Auditor's Office Data Import Consulting Contract**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jessica Piper, County Council President.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to fund an initial assessment (approx. \$1,200) by a software/consulting vendor to determine if job classification data (approx. 5,000 data fields) can be bulk-imported rather than entered manually, avoiding severe administrative burden and errors. Funds were previously approved by Council.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote [00:32:06](#).
- [00:34:50](#) **ARPA Administrative Consulting Contracts (Baker Tilly, Dosset, OpenGov, etc.)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Administration.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** A package of administrative agreements (including Baker Tilly, Dosset Consulting, Unique Computer Services, and OpenGov) not to exceed \$142,700 total, necessary to ensure compliance with shifting federal Treasury guidelines and obligate all ARPA funds by the end of the year. Staff cited over 700 hours spent on compliance.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote [00:37:14](#).
- [00:37:25](#) **First Reading: Ordinance 2024-31 (EMS Billing Rates)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mike Ashley, Delaware County EMS Director.
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Increases EMS billing rates to comply with House Bill 1385 (requiring private insurance to pay up to 4x Medicare rates). Does not affect Medicare or Medicaid, and self-pay discounts are increased (self-pay constitutes only 5% of payer mix). Rates have not increased since 2019.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
    - Introduced as Ordinance 2024-31.
    - Rules suspended by roll call vote [00:40:19](#).
    - Adopted by Roll Call Vote [00:40:31](#).
- [00:44:02](#) **Second Reading: Ordinance 2024-30 (Vacation of Platted Alley in Liberty Lane, Selma)**
  - **Sponsor / Presenter:** David K., Attorney (Dennis & Cole).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Second reading to vacate an undeveloped platted road/alley on Liberty Lane between two agreeing property owners (Kimberly Honing and Stephanie Clark).
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by Roll Call Vote [00:44:56](#).
- [00:41:41](#) **First Reading: Ordinance 2024-32 (Transferring ARPA Interest Earned)**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Administration / Matt Couch (County Council Attorney).
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Addresses interest earned on ARPA deposits. County Council noted that projected 2025 budgets incorporated this interest revenue for salary adjustments, raising concerns over a potential shortfall. Administration noted federal Treasury guidelines recently changed regarding how ARPA interest must be handled in a separate fund rather than general revenue recovery, requiring ordinance revisions before year-end.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced only (00:43:23); revisions to be brought back before year-end.
- 

## 5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

---

*No general public comments were recorded during the open public comment period at the conclusion of the meeting, though several department heads and elected officials spoke during earlier agenda slots:* - 00:15:15 **Rick Conrad** (Muncie Sanitary District) <U+2014> Spoke on property tax abatement. - 00:45:15 **Tony Skinner** (Delaware County Sheriff) <U+2014> Spoke strongly in support of the IRAX program, highlighting its 16.5% recidivism rate compared to state prison rates. - 00:48:14 **Pam (HR Director)** <U+2014> Clarified handbook review timelines.

---

## 6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

---

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
    - Approval of transfer of a surplus 2016 MedX ambulance to the Eaton EMTs for re-chassising (00:49:27).
    - Approval of claims (\$2,084,276.87), ARPA claims (\$1,660), and payroll (\$1,333,824) [00:50:08 – 00:50:50].
    - **Next Meeting:** Special Year-End Clean-up Meeting scheduled for **Monday, December 30, 2024, at 10:00 AM** 00:51:09.
  - **Adjournment:** Motion to recess/adjourn passed by roll call vote 00:51:36.
- 

*Muncie Policy Memo Civic Monitoring Automated Pipeline. Report generated on 2026-10-01 02:01:35 using model gemini-3.5-flash-lite.*